Vidyasagar, lies in how "diverse, ambitious and complex" it is and driven by youngsters hungry to learn and grow. "It's not just one vector, one type of content shining. The plurality of formats and verticals and languages has led to this extraordinary inflection," he adds.

What's driving this creative explosion? The widespread access to affordable internet and cheaper smartphones certainly, making it easier to consume content on social media. But it is also the lightning speed at which content is being created and going viral, leaving you with no choice but to take note. Take, for instance, the delightful "Prashant" meme. In this short split-screen English tutorial video—titled "What is this called?"—young creator Ayush mispronounces an AI-generated enunciation of croissant as Prashant. Ever since it broke the internet in March, the quirky video has amassed over 17 million views, even landing Ayush an ad with Philips Home Living where he relishes, what else, a croissant while promoting an air fryer.

BEING SEEN WITH CREATORS IS A MEANS TO KEEP UP WITH POP CULTURE TRENDS. PERHAPS WHY YOU SEE BILL GATES HAVING TEA WITH THE FLAMBOYANT DOLLY CHAI WALA

What's fascinating is that creators don't even have to follow any logic or lofty standards for their content; anything and everything goes. How else does one explain the virality of Assam's Rajkumar Thakuria, popularly known as Raku Da? A 70-year-old retired banker, his 'cringe pop' renditions with titles like 'You are a doctor, I am a driver', have struck a chord way beyond Northeast India, winning him 80,000+ subscribers on YouTube and 236,000 followers on Instagram.

Being seen with creators has now become a means to keep up with pop culture trends and remain relevant. And so it is that Bill Gates is sitting down for an interview with one of India's most

Food Inspector General

Revant Himantsingka is an anomaly among creators. Best known as the nutrition influencer who pulled up Bournvita for its high sugar content in his very first video, prompting a legal notice; compelled Lay's to switch from palm to sunflower oil in India; and started the campaign 'Label Padhega India', Revant is better known as a 'de-influencer'—someone who criticises brands for falling short on delivering the healthy food they ardently promise.

"The first year, I didn't make any money," says Revant, who put in his savings from a job in the US into his creative foray. "I have one policy—don't do any food brand deals. I have been offered insane amounts...." These days, financial services firm Zerodha is sponsoring the production cost of his latest podcast, *The Simple Health Series*. Happily, a plywood brand has also approached him because he stands for "trust and credibility". ■ **SS**

REVANT HIMATSINGKA, *33*
FOOD PHARMER
MUMBAI

1.25 MILLION subscribers
2.8 MILLION followers



MANDAR DEODHAR